

INCREMENT-BASED CORRELATION COEFFICIENT (CHESKIDOV'S)

BY ROMAN CHESKIDOV^{1,a}, ALENA CHESKIDOVA^{2,b}

¹Independent Researcher, ^acheskidov.research@gmail.com

²Ural Federal University, Yekaterinburg, Russia, ^balena.cheskidova@urfu.ru

The article introduces the Increment-Based Concordance Correlation Coefficient (Cheskidov's) — Increment-based CCC or CCC — as a unit-free, consistent measure of synchrony that overcomes Pearson's limitations in nonlinear and oscillatory data. By focusing on mutual increments, CCC matches Pearson in monotonic cases but avoids false correlations in complex contexts, making it especially suited for ordered time-series such as financial or climate data. It reliably identifies true dependencies while remaining stable near zero for oscillatory patterns, offering a robust, complementary tool for modern data analysis where directionality of change is crucial.

1. Introduction. The study of dependence between random variables lies at the core of modern statistics and data analysis. From the classical works of Galton and Pearson, correlation has served as a quantitative measure of how two quantities vary together. The Pearson correlation coefficient (PCC) captures linear dependence, while later developments such as Spearman's rank correlation and Kendall's tau extend this idea to monotonic but potentially nonlinear relationships. Despite their wide adoption, these coefficients rely on covariance around mean levels and thus describe positional alignment rather than the synchrony of changes.

In many real-world systems—financial, biological, or physical—the relationships between variables are dynamic and oscillatory, not monotonic. In such settings, PCC may indicate moderate positive or negative correlations even when the underlying processes are symmetric or directionally uncorrelated. This limitation motivates the search for correlation measures that reflect the *coherence of directional changes* rather than static alignment.

We introduce the *Increment-Based Concordance Correlation Coefficient (Cheskidov's)*, abbreviated as CCC, which quantifies synchrony between ordered sequences based on their increments. CCC evaluates how consistently two sequences increase or decrease together, thus characterizing the concordance of change rather than their mean-centered association. The coefficient takes values in the interval $[-1, 1]$, equals ± 1 for strictly monotonic relationships, and approaches 0 for oscillatory or symmetric forms.

The CCC provides a robust analytical framework for datasets where the direction of change carries interpretive significance—such as time series with alternating trends, cyclic dynamics in climate or physiology, and adaptive learning processes. In these contexts, CCC remains stable under nonlinear transformations and resistant to misleading correlations typical of mean-based measures.

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section 2 presents the mathematical formulation of CCC and its theoretical properties. Section 3 compares CCC with classical correlation measures on monotonic and oscillatory datasets. Section 4 discusses potential applications and computational aspects. Section 5 concludes with remarks on the broader implications of increment-based correlation in modern data analysis. This study addresses

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that inconsistency by introducing the *Increment-Based Concordance Correlation Coefficient* (*Cheskidov's*)—abbreviated as CCC. The method provides a differential approach to dependence measurement, focusing on the synchrony of directional changes rather than covariance around mean levels.